

## Unit Y317: China and its Rulers 1839–1989

This theme focuses on the nature of Chinese government and its impact on Chinese people, society and the wider world. Learners should understand the similarities and differences between the nature of the Qing dynasty in Imperial China, the Presidency of Yuan Shikai, the Warlord Era, the Nationalist Government and the Communist government after 1949. The

strands identified below are not to be studied in isolation to each other.

Learners are not expected to demonstrate a detailed knowledge of the specification content, except for the named in-depth studies, but are expected to know the main developments and turning points relevant to the theme.

| <b>Thematic Study: China and its Rulers 1839–1989</b> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
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| <b>Key Topics</b>                                     | <b>Content</b><br><b>Learners should have studied the following:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>The government and rulers of China 1839–1989</b>   | Nature of Manchu rule in 1839; reasons for and response to rebellions; obstacles to reform under Xi Xi, reforms after 1900; reasons for the 1911 Revolution; Sun Yat Sen and the new Republic; the rule of Yuan Shikai; the Guomindang and Jiang Jieshi; the Communist takeover; the government of China under Mao Zedong; changes after 1975; Deng Xiaoping.                             |
| <b>The economy of China 1839–1989</b>                 | The Chinese economy in 1839; developments in Manchu China: railways, trade and industry, agrarian problems; the industrial and urban development under the Guomindang; Land reform under Communism; the Four Year Plans; the Great Leap Forward; economic policy in the later years of Mao and its impact; changes in the economy under Mao's successors; regional variations after 1975. |
| <b>Society in China 1839–1989</b>                     | Society in China under Manchu rule; Confucianism; the role of women; rural society; social changes in the later Manchu period; the Boxers; social developments after 1911; social factors in the rise of Communism; social change after 1949; the Cultural Revolution and Chinese society; social development after 1975; the rise of the middle class.                                   |
| <b>China and the wider world</b>                      | Foreign influence in Manchu China: the Opium Wars, the sack of Beijing and the Unequal Treaties; the international reaction to the Boxer Rebellion; Japanese aggression and war 1898–1945; Jiang Jieshi and relations with the USSR and the USA; the Korean War; relations with the West after 1949; China as a regional power in South Asia.                                             |

| <b>China and its rulers 1839–1989</b>     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
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| <b>Depth Studies</b>                      | <b>Content</b><br><b>Learners should be aware of debates surrounding the issues outlined for each in-depth topic:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>The First Opium War and its impact</b> | China and the Western powers by 1839; long and short-term causes of the First Opium War, including the issue of the opium trade; the influence of Commissioner Lin and the British reaction; outbreak and nature of war; Ch'uan-pi Convention 1841; Treaty of Nanjing 1842 and the Treaty of the Bogue 1843; results of the war on China and relations with the West including the 'Unequal Treaties'.                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>The Boxer Uprising</b>                 | Resentment of foreign influence; the impact of the coup of 1898, economic hardships; origin of the I-ho ch'uan (Boxers) and their links to the Court, attacks on foreign legations, refusal of Southeast China to join the war against foreigners, actions by foreign forces, defeat of uprising, consequences including the Boxer protocol of 1901; the Russian expansion in Manchuria; the Open Door policy; the reputation of China and the weakening of the dynasty.                                                                                                |
| <b>The Cultural Revolution</b>            | Origins and causes; problems by 1966; the impact of the failure of the Great Leap Forward; Mao's concerns about the progress of the Revolution and Liu Shao-chi; disappointment with attempts to radicalise 1963–1964; influence of Lin Biao, Chen Boda, Jiang Qing and Gang of Four; changes in Politburo 1966, influence of the army; nature and course of the Cultural Revolution, activities of the Red Guards, decline of violence, demobilisation of Red Guards 1969 and death of Lin Biao 1971; effects of the Cultural Revolution: economic, political, social. |